

Facebook Poke

Facebook announced a new app called Poke which is a message and photo-sharing app similar Snapchat, where the sent post self destructs after the set time



Chrome 25 update

Google announced that Chrome 25 will disable silent extensions installation in Windows by default



LG Optimus L-Series Crosses 10 Million Sales Mark

Apart from selling in 50 markets worldwide and sporting distinctive design elements, LG drew attention to some of the reasons why the Optimus L-series smartphone has been this successful. Apart from offering a range of display sizes, it has proprietary interface features like QuickMemo and QTranslator – the former lets you capture and share a note with other users of the app, while the latter lets you translate words and sentences into 64 foreign languages.

Motorola Mobility shuts down India operations

Motorola Mobility India has announced it is shutting down its India operations. This is a part of Motorola's global down-sizing process. Motorola had made it clear back in August 2012 that it will be streamlining its global operations. The company had said that they will reduce workforce by 30 per cent and shut down a third of its offices globally. The roadmap also included exiting all unprofitable markets, focus on quality and not quantity of phones they sell and exit the budget Android segment completely.

Google acquired Motorola Mobility for \$12.5 billion in May this year, on the back of

heavy losses last year. Motorola Mobility is totally independent from Motorola Solutions. Incidentally, Motorola's plan that it will aggressively compete with the rival Android manufacturers for phones, including the Nexus range, is not turning out as well as it had hoped.

One of the implications of this move would be that we would not see any new handsets from Motorola in the near future, for starters. Whatever handsets are available in the markets will be sold, but no fresh stocks will replenish the shelves. Service centres will remain open "well into the future" according to Motorola.

The company also indefinitely suspended operations at its assembly unit in Chennai. The move will affect 76 employees at the facility. Motorola Mobility Corporate Communications (Asia Pacific) Director William Moss is quoted as saying, "We are now fulfilling customer orders directly from factories, and we have no current or forecast production requirements that would require the continued use of our Chennai facility."

New Global Announcements

Globally, HTC has announced that its mid-range Android

smartphone, the One SV, will be made available in the UK soon. No global pricing or availability of the smartphone was announced however. The ICS-based HTC One SV has a 4.3-inch Super LCD2 capacitive touchscreen with a resolution of 480 x 800 pixels, and Gorilla Glass 2 protection. It has a dual-core 1.2 GHz Snapdragon S4 processor and 1 GB of RAM, coupled with 8 GB built-in storage, a microSD card slot, and 25 GB via Dropbox. It comes with Beats Audio, and supports 4G LTE with HSDPA speeds up to 42 Mbps. It sports



HTC One SV

a 5 MP rear camera 1080p HD video recording, and a front-facing 1.6 MP camera.

Samsung has also announced a new smartphone, the Galaxy Grand, which boasts of dual-SIM capabilities and runs on Android 4.1.2 Jelly Bean. No launch date or price of the smartphone has been revealed. In terms of other specifications under the hood, the Galaxy Grand boasts of a dual-core 1.2 GHz processor and 1 GB of RAM. The rear houses an 8 MP snapper with the ability to shoot HD video and the front has a 2 MP video-calling camera. It

also sports 8 GB built-in storage expandable up to 64 GB via a microSD card. It has a 5-inch display, with a disappointing 480x800 pixel resolution.

Nokia also announced a low cost Windows Phone 7.8 device, the Nokia Lumia 505, which will launch on Mexico's Telcel network in the upcoming weeks. There is no word on the pricing of the smartphone or its availability in any other part of the world. The Lumia 505 bears a 3.7-inch AMOLED display, a single-core 800MHz CPU along with 256MB of RAM. It has an 8 MP rear camera. Built-in storage is just 4 GB with no microSD card slot. Nokia and Microsoft will however provide 7 GB of free SkyDrive storage with the Lumia 505.

Nokia also announced the Lumia 620, currently retailing for \$249 in the U.S., without a contract. A WP8 handset with a 3.8-inch ClearBlack WVGA display, the Lumia 620 is powered by a 1 GHz dual-core processor and 512 MB of RAM. It sports a 5 MP camera, a front-facing VGA camera, a microSD card slot, as well as a 1,300 mAh battery rated to deliver a standby time of 330 hours and talktime of 14.6 hours. No Indian pricing or release date has been mentioned.

Sony has also added a smartphone to its budget line up, the Xperia E, with Android 4.1 Jelly Bean straight out of the box. The Xperia E is expected to hit store shelves early next year. It has a 3.5-inch HVGA display with a resolution of 480 x 320 pixels, coupled with a 1 GHz single-core Snapdragon S1 processor, 512 MB of RAM and 4 GB built-in storage. It has a 3.2 MP camera, a 1500mAh battery. It is lightweight, at 115 grams, and measures 11mm in thickness. Sony has also announced a dual-SIM version of the Xperia E, called the Xperia E dual.